

THIS IS NOT ALL MEANT TO BE MEMORISED, JUST SKIM AND TAKE NOTE OF WHAT IS USEFUL. as for characters/themes i'd say only 3/4 quotes per section needs to be memorised, gll :) -ifty
themes are the first half scroll down for characters

Setting

(QUOTES ON SETTING A FEW SECTIONS BELOW)

Verisimilitude is the semblance of reality. When a fantasy setting is grounded within reality, it creates an unsettling effect **as we can relate to it.**

London mirrors J – outwardly nice, hides corruption. The setting is a *macrocosm of human duality*. London mirrors the fractured, feeble psyche of J/H... suggesting below the polished surface of Vic. respectability lies a repressed and dangerous darkness. (this duality reflected throughout the setting in places like J's house)

The setting of Victorian London gives us an invitation to sympathise with Jekyll as it was a highly repressive place. Enjoyments were cast away with the excuse of religion – Utterson himself drinks gin to "*mortify a taste for vintages*". However, upon further examination this too is ironic as gin is a drink associated with the lower-class. This coping mechanism is in fact more destructive than the other option – it was associated with poverty, crime and addiction.

Setting mirrors the character perfectly, (see quotes below the context section on Setting) and is masterfully manipulated by S to almost justify Jekyll/Hyde's actions – H was in Soho, a place of evil and one is influenced by their habitat, likewise J was a typical Victorian gentleman expected to repress all enjoyable avenues of life.

Props such as Utterson's safe reflect secrecy and maybe even social/moral constriction, more imagery of eg. "*Windows barred with iron*" etc. **reflect psychological imprisonment** – J (and by extension, the whole of society) is trapped by expectation.

...and some context

Utterson's "abstinence" is in truth him simply managing desire rather than eliminating it, *similarly to Jekyll*. In a Victorian society, abstinence is not practiced, rather behind the scenes it is just displaced into a form socially accepted. (more on this below)

Jekyll can be seen to be based upon John Hunter ("*The doctor had bought the house from the heirs of a celebrated surgeon*") who was an accomplished scientist (**regarded as founder of scientific surgery!**) who was one of the first early scientists, treating complicated stuff like aneurysms through his knowledge gained by dissecting over 200 bodies – these cadavers were supplied by grave robbers – *knowledge costs*.

Hunter's house on Leicester square had a back-way through castle st., a quiet

backstreet – and most importantly, the ground plan is identical to the descriptions in the novella.

During the writing of the book

Writing J&H almost killed Stevenson. 2w before he began, he was coughing up blood (TB) and his doctor prescribed ergotine, which is what he was on when writing j&h. The drug mentioned triggers spasms and hallucinations – it worked by constricting blood vessels and thus preventing bleeding. his hallucinations and nightmares fuelled j&h's plot, indeed it was when he was dreaming J's transformation into H he was awoken by his wife.

When the book was writ, the law outlawing homosexuality began to be enforced. At the time, there were a lot of same-sex scandals which led to Hyde being seen as more of a scandalous (in relation to sexual crimes) character than a current reader would see now. Basically, even though it's hard to see H as gay right now, a repressed Victorian mind would infer a lot.

Deacon Brodie

Deacon Brodie – a respectable citizen living a double life. He was addicted to gambling and to fund this, he turned to burglary ("hamesucking"). His profession as a cabinet maker allowed him to make copies of the door keys of his customers while working. He would return in the night to steal. The robber "sporting very dashing attire", as described by one old woman with "a mask, a brace of pistols and a lantern." His reputation shielded him from suspicion. Edinburgh's Excise office was the last place he tried robbing. Apprehended, he was tried and hanged.

Stevenson was scared of Brodie – he had a cabinet that was made by the robber.

setting (cont'd)

Quotes on Setting:

- "Cavendish Square, that citadel of medicine" – describing L
- "Round the corner from the by-street, there was a square of ancient, handsome houses, now for the most part decayed from their high estate and let in flats and chambers to all sorts and conditions of men; map-engravers, architects, shady lawyers and the agents of obscure enterprises. One house, however, second from the corner, was still occupied entire; and at the door of this, which wore a great air of wealth and comfort, though it was now plunged in darkness except for the fanlight, Mr. Utterson stopped and knocked. A well-dressed, elderly servant opened the door."
- "Utterson himself was wont to speak of it as the pleasantest room in London."
- The dismal quarter of Soho seen under these changing glimpses, with its muddy ways, and slatternly passengers, and its lamps, which had never been extinguished or had been kindled afresh to combat this mournful reinvasion of

darkness, seemed, in the lawyer's eyes, like a district of some city in a nightmare.

- "The dismal quarter of Soho seemed... in the lawyer's eyes, like a district of some city in a nightmare."
- "That evening Mr. Utterson came home to his bachelor house in sombre spirits and sat down to dinner without relish."

the fog:

- "Mr. Utterson beheld a marvelous number of degrees and hues of twilight; for here it would be dark like the back-end of evening; and there would be a glow of a rich, lurid brown, like the light of some strange conflagration; and here, for a moment, the fog would be quite broken up, and a haggard shaft of daylight would glance in between the swirling wreaths"
 - "as brown as umber"
 - "fog rolled over the city in the small hours"
 - "A great chocolate-coloured pall lowered over heaven"
 - "the fog still slept on the wing above the drowned city"
-

Hyde is situated in Soho – which is a dark and dingy neighbourhood associated with crime and poverty – "a dingy street, a gin palace, a low French eating house, a shop for the retail of penny numbers and twopenny salads, many ragged children huddled in the doorways, and many women of many different nationalities passing out, key in hand, to have a morning glass"

Friendship and Relations

Utterson and Jekyll's relationship moves from friendliness and goodness to a more professional relation in the role of a lawyer. This is because as time progresses, Utterson begins to discover the grotesque truth about Jekyll, yet as a Victorian gentleman he is not to destroy the former's reputation, which would be unseemly in the Victorian era. Instead, Utterson maintains his ties, veiling the truth and hiding the reality of Henry Jekyll from all.

If Utterson had raised suspicion on Jekyll from the beginning, perhaps there still would remain a Henry Jekyll. Even when he realises something is going on when Guest compares the script of Hyde and Jekyll, he simply remarks "I wouldn't speak of this note, you know", a veiled threat implying that nothing should be said of this.

Despite Utterson being portrayed as a detective, he is abysmal in his role of one – ignoring blatant leads under the excuse of reputation.

Key quotes on friendship:

- "It was a nut to crack for many, what these two could see in each other, or what subject they could find in common. It was reported by those who encountered them in their Sunday walks, that they said nothing, looked

singularly dull and would hail with obvious relief the appearance of a friend."

- in Jekyll's passing, "all his possessions were to pass into the hands of his friend and benefactor Edward Hyde"
- J to U: "I beg of you to let it sleep."
- Later on J to U again: "I bind my honour to you that I am done with him in this world."
- do more
- ""

More on reputation

U/E avoid gossip. V society will crumble without the struts of repute.

Key quotes on reputation:

- U: "I incline to Cain's heresy"
- E: "The more it looks like queer street the less I ask"
- E: "make his name stink from one end of London to the other" – this is the next best option from killing – "killing being out of the question, we did the next best."
- J refers to H as a "sea of liberty", suggesting that the mantle of reputation is heavy to bear. Followed up similarly by "like a schoolboy"
- "Windows barred with iron" – repression?
- "the fanciful was the immodest" – V idea of denying pleasures

The duality of Man

The term "duality" is one of some variability, it could be proclaimed that Hyde is simply a Jekyll who is liberated from societal norms. We can all relate to J to a greater or lesser extent as we all live double lives (to some level), the version of us that we wish to be is usually not the façade we portray outwardly – perhaps S is lamenting upon the loss of so many different personalities due to moral and social constraints.

Key quotes:

- "I was coming home from some place at the end of the world, about three o'clock of a black winter morning" – allusion to brothels visited by the UC? E is a well-known man about town, after all.
- "Hence, although I had now two characters as well as two appearances, one was wholly evil, and the other was still the old Henry Jekyll, that incongruous compound of whose reformation and improvement I had already learned to despair. The movement was thus wholly toward the worse."
- "She had an evil face, smoothed by hypocrisy: but her manners were excellent."
- LONDON & SOHO
- "if I am the chief of sinners, I am the chief of sufferers too"
- "man is truly one, but truly two"

- "Though so profound a double-dealer, I was in no sense a hypocrite; both sides of me were in dead earnest"
- "these were furnished with luxury and good taste"
- "all human beings, as we meet them, are commingled out of good and evil" – commingled – sense of closeness – thin line of evil and good
- "drank gin when alone to mortify a taste for vintages"
- "these polar twins should be continuously struggling" – oxymoron – contrasting, but really are the same in truth
- "the very pink of the proprieties" "a really damnable man"

Good vs. Evil

Science and Religion

Victorians were *puritanic* and believed that suffering was needed to expunge the sin of man. They also believed in original sin.

Stevenson was atheist. His moral message may be against institutional religion (specifically puritans) due to its repression?

First of all, why was religion needed in a Victorian society? Perhaps its role of structuring society was required – a moral framework of sorts held the Victorians together. Religion also justified repression, ie. pleasure being morally suspect unless tightly controlled. Religion also controlled the masses, which arguably was good.

Science was the new contender, where it was all about pushing limits. For instance, the two sides of the human psyche were ripped apart through Jekyll's experiments. Science is the unleashing of desire, desire that was previously repressed by society.

A "middle ground" seems to be argued by Stevenson – for instance, the refusal to change such as Lanyon's static, fixed worldview that is why Jekyll calls him a "pedant". Lanyon is too bound to the rational (Hyde says, "*you who have so long been bound to the most narrow and material views, you who have denied the virtue of transcendental medicine, you who have derided your superiors...*") However, on the other side of the compass, Jekyll – a man who was killed by curiosity.

In the Victorian era, people were beginning to question the ideals of progress and pessimism around development evolved much like today's AI situation. Lanyon and Jekyll represent the rational and supernatural branches of science.

Creationism (christian belief that man was created by God "in his own image") was prevalent but when Darwin published "On the Origin of Species" in '59 this doctrine was challenged. (book published in 1886, for some reference.) Many believed that science was overstepping its right and through meddlers like Jekyll would bring the destruction of society. Stevenson preys on fears like atavism, Hyde suggests that meddling will unleash our primitive selves.

Key quotes:

- "there lay the body of a man sorely contorted and still twitching." – science changed Jekyll (phrase "sorely contorted") as it "contorted" his very self
- "If I am the chief of sinners, I am the chief of sufferers also."
- "You must suffer me to go my own dark way. I have brought on myself a punishment and a danger that I cannot name."
- *"what follows is under the seal of our profession. And now, you who have so long been bound to the most narrow and material views, you who have denied the virtue of transcendental medicine, you who have derided your superiors— behold!"* – Hyde to Lanyon
- "'O God!' I screamed, and 'O God!' again and again..."
- "hide-bound pedant, Lanyon, at what he called my scientific heresies." "ignorant, blatant pedant"
- "But it is more than ten years since Henry Jekyll became too fanciful for me. He began to go wrong, wrong in mind; and though of course I continue to take an interest in him for old sake's sake, as they say, I see and I have seen devilish little of the man. Such unscientific balderdash," added the doctor, flushing suddenly purple, "would have estranged Damon and Pythias."
- "Your sight shall be blasted by a prodigy to stagger the unbelief of Satan!"
- "Jekyll became too fanciful for me. He began to go wrong, wrong in mind... such unscientific balderdash..."
- "hide-bound pedant" "ignorant, blatant pedant"
- "it doesn't commend itself to reason"

Mystery

Mystery is a veil for evil allowing it to hide from goodness. Mystery is a common gothic trope that permeates the novella – it is present to build suspense and obscurity, keeping readers hooked.

The narrative itself is shrouded in mystery, indeed we are only fed tit-bits of the plot through letters and investigation. The readers are invited to ponder and piece information together slowly.

The fragmented perspectives of U/E/L create knowledge gaps that increase tension levels.

Secrecy

Key quotes:

- "the door which was equipped with neither bell nor knocker was blistered and disdained"
 - "I am ashamed of my long tongue. Let us make a bargain never to refer to this again."
 - "dingy, windowless structure" – "structure" connotes a place not worthy of residing in
 - "i mean from henceforth to lead a life of extreme seclusion;... you must suffer me to go my own dark way"
- Even the fog:
- "A great chocolate-coloured pall lowered over heaven"

- "for a moment, the fog would be quite broken up, and a haggard shaft of daylight would glance in between the swirling wreaths."
- "the fog lifted a little", "the fog settled down again upon that part, as brown as umber, and cut him off" it's a literal veil

Miscellaneous

The Gothic Genre

Began in the 18th century, permeated the arts of the Victorian era. Horror fiction and romanticism were frankensteined together. The genre encapsulates "*pleasing horror*" and mirrors the V's fascination with otherworldly beings. Common tropes were violence, science and atavism (devolution into more primitive beings).

Key elements were doubling (doppelgängers, duality...), pathetic fallacy "the fog rolled over the city"... and grotesque imagery (like "the bones were audibly shattered").

Strong setting, sense of the supernatural, mystery... were themes used.

Physiognomy

Lombroso was a criminologist who theorised that the "born criminal" could be recognised by physical traits, like Hyde with his "troglodytic" appearance which was "hardly human".

The theory is undermined by S, as J is allowed to wander society freely – criminals can be hypocrites under the guise of reputation.

Propriety – the model Gentleman

Conduct as a Victorian was meant to be rigid – men were expected to refrain from pleasures (U's gin), have sexual restraint and have a strict social/moral code of conduct in adherence usually to religion. S critiques this through H being at home in the darkness of London, where countless crimes occur without anyone knowing. Even E comes back from "someplace at the end of the world".

Freud's psychoanalysis

F believed that humans are strongly influenced by unaware impulses (which could manifest in dreams). H may represent J's subconscious desire to be rid of society's repression. F's theory of the id (bad), superego (good) and ego (the judge between the two). (see sheet)

The fin de siècle

This term means "the end of the century". The novella was written in 1886 and reflects the changing moral landscape and decay of the Victorian era which was struggling to maintain law and order – physical, social, moral, urban decay is all present. The novella depicts the decay of humanity on every level – it's as if humanity is undergoing atavism.

Addiction

Sexual predation, rising crimes and alcohol (mostly gin) and drugs like opium were all prevalent as a result of rapid urban expansion. Jekyll's desperation for the powder ("the drug is wanted bitter bad", says Poole) – the incident at the window reflects on a man struggling to withdraw from his habit.

The Industrial Revolution

More jobs created, so more people move to the cities which become cramped and overcrowded. The ensuing poverty also relates to the boom in crime. Major cities were dangerous to be in. As medical schools paid good money for dead bodies, there was a rise in murder (in specific, poor people). Graves were robbed by thieves to the point that cages were placed upon the soil they were buried under. S was intrigued with duality in respectable figures such as Deacon Brodie.

Isolation

Urbanisation led to communities with looser social bonds and greater anonymity than the close-knit extended family rural structure. All the gentlemen in the novella live alone – S may be reflecting fears of social disintegration.

Corruption and the City

Stevenson was raised in Edinburgh which was distinctly separated into two sides – the old and new town. There were bridges built so gentlemen could go to the old town (associated with prostitution...) and even London is portrayed as a corrupt, crime-infested place. The duality of the city reflects the decay of morality.

Characters

Dr. Henry Jekyll

Jekyll begins as a well-respected scientist constrained by strict societal expectations which lead him to conclude that his subconscious desires, being incompatible with his public image, he develops the potion allowing him to morph into Hyde, the embodiment of the evil and darkness of Henry Jekyll.

The two sides begin to war with each other, Hyde wishing to take over without Jekyll's consent. Jekyll stops taking the potion and assumes the role of a model Victorian gentleman, when one day after two months he *"began to be tortured with throes and longing"*, he relapses and sips the draught, upon which Hyde is unleashed – *"My devil had been long caged, he came out roaring."* Carew was murdered. Jekyll shows great remorse but joy at the impossibility of Hyde: *"As the acuteness of this remorse began to die away, it was succeeded by a sense of joy. The problem of my conduct was solved. Hyde was thenceforth impossible; whether I would or not, I was now confined to the better part of my existence; and O, how I rejoiced to think of it! with what willing humility I embraced anew the restrictions of natural life! with what sincere renunciation I locked the door by which I had so often gone and come, and ground the key under my heel!"*. He remains Jekyll until he sits one day in Regent's Park, *"comparing myself with other men, comparing my active good-will with the lazy cruelty of their neglect"* – upon this, Hyde again is unleashed. The boundary between the two selves has

been blurred. He manages to get Lanyon to deliver the drugs of the draught, exposing his double life in the process which shocks Lanyon. Jekyll begins to start requiring double doses to stay himself, and begins to transform under the span of six hours. Soon, he can only be Jekyll under immediate doses. And soon, his supply runs out and he is not able to maintain the dual persona. He reflects that he is *"persuaded that [his] first supply was impure, and that it was that unknown impurity which lent efficacy to the draught."* His supply ending, writing upon the throes of the end of the last bit of original powders, he becomes resignedly acquiescent over his fate, concluding Hyde awaits execution or must take his own life.

Key Quotes:

- "he began to go wrong, wrong in mind" "such unscientific balderdash" "would have estranged Pythias and Damon"
- "large, well-made, smooth-faced man of fifty with something of a slyish cast perhaps, but every mark of capacity and kindness"
- "disconsolate prisoner"
- "my devil had been long caged. he came out roaring."
- "If I am the chief of sinners, I am the chief of sufferers also."
- "He, I say—I cannot say, I."
- "With Jekyll, it was a thing of vital instinct. He had now seen the full deformity of that creature that shared with him some of the phenomena of consciousness, and was co-heir with him to death"
- "I have been doomed to such a dreadful shipwreck: that man is not truly one, but truly two."
- "I was in no sense a hypocrite; both sides of me were in dead earnest" – reputation
- "O my poor old Harry Jekyll..."
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Mr. Edward Hyde

The reason for Hyde's origin is this: the need for Jekyll to have an outlet for J's suppressed desires. Early on, his actions are disturbing but controlled. As the story progresses, Hyde begins to grow bolder, indeed he *"trampled calmly"* over a child's body and Jekyll describes that *"With a transport of glee, [hyde] mauled the unresisting body, tasting delight from every blow;.."* – no longer is he just J's darker side, but a force that feeds on freedom and each appearance he makes is harder to suppress. Eventually, he begins to emerge without the potion, indicating the fusion of the two personalities – J is H and H is J, H is an emerging identity that becomes increasingly less contingent upon Jekyll. However, lacking J's self-restraint and observation of Victorian morals, he is a social outcast and wanted for execution after the murder of Carew. Trapped in J's lab, he meets his end there with a bottle of poison in his hand – *"Utterson knew he was looking upon the body of a self-destroyer"*. Ultimately, Stevenson may be explaining that our unchecked impulses – once unleashed – can grow stronger than ourselves.

Key Quotes:

- "trampled calmly"
- "the man seems hardly human! Something troglodytic"
- "dwarfish, he gave the impression of deformity without any nameable malformation"
- "ape-like fury" "he broke out in a great flame of anger" "Mr Hyde broke out of all bounds and clubbed him to the earth."
- "he was trampling his victim underfoot and hailing down a storm of blows, under which the bones were audibly shattered and the body jumped upon the roadway"
- "No, sir; ... I can't describe him. And it's not want of memory; for I declare I can see him this moment.""
- "all human beings, as we meet them, are commingled out of good and evil: and Edward Hyde, alone in the ranks of mankind, was pure evil."
- "friend and benefactor"
- "unexpressed deformity"
- "satan's signature upon a face"
- "Jekyll had more than a father's interest; Hyde more than a son's indifference"

Dr. Hastie Lanyon

Begins as a respectable, "orthodox" physician who is firm in his scientific beliefs. Used to be close friends with Jekyll, until the latter "*began to go wrong, wrong in mind*" – J's "balderdash" reveals Lanyon's aversion to the irrational and unorthodox. Later on, a desperate Hyde writes to him for materials for the potion, which when delivered he is given the choice to watch the transformation, which he answers affirmatively. The curiosity 'kills the cat', so to say, and his worldview is shattered as the laws of rationality he knows are destroyed. His mind is lost, this is his breaking point – unable to reconcile something thought to be impossible – he turns ill, undergoing (both physical and psychological) deterioration and dies shortly after.

Key quotes:

- "...and set forth in the direction of Cavendish Square, that citadel of medicine, where his friend, *the great Dr. Lanyon*, had his house and received his crowding patients"
- "Healthy, hearty, dapper, red-faced gentleman"
- "boisterous and decided manner"
- "He began to go wrong, wrong in mind; and though of course I continue to take an interest in him for old sake's sake, as they say, I see and I have seen devilish little of the man. Such unscientific balderdash," added the doctor, flushing suddenly purple, "would have estranged Damon and Pythias.""
- "that hide-bound pedant, Lanyon, at what he called my scientific heresies. O, I know he's a good fellow—you needn't frown—an excellent fellow, and I always mean to see more of him; but a hide-bound pedant for all that; an ignorant, blatant pedant. I was never more disappointed in any man than Lanyon.""

- "Or, if you shall so prefer to choose, a new province of knowledge and new avenues to fame and power shall be laid open to you, here, in this room, upon the instant; and your sight shall be blasted by a prodigy to stagger the unbelief of Satan.""
- "Lanyon, you remember your vows: what follows is under the seal of our profession. And now, *you who have so long been bound to the most narrow and material views, you who have denied the virtue of transcendental medicine, you who have derided your superiors*—behold!"
- "My life is shaken to its roots; sleep has left me; the deadliest terror sits by me at all hours of the day and night; and I feel that my days are numbered, and that I must die; and yet I shall die incredulous. As for the moral turpitude that man unveiled to me, even with tears of penitence, I cannot, even in memory, dwell on it without a start of horror."
- "He had his death-warrant written legibly upon his face."
- "The rosy man had grown pale"
- "his flesh had fallen away"
- "he was visibly balder and older"
- "But Lanyon's face changed, and he held up a trembling hand. "I wish to see or hear no more of Dr. Jekyll," he said in a loud, unsteady voice. "I am quite done with that person; and I beg that you will spare me any allusion to one whom I regard as dead.""
- "'PRIVATE: for the hands of G. J. Utterson ALONE, and in case of his predecease *to be destroyed unread*," so it was emphatically superscribed; and the lawyer dreaded to behold the contents. "I have buried one friend to-day," he thought: "what if this should cost me another?" And then he condemned the fear as a disloyalty, and broke the seal. Within there was another enclosure, likewise sealed, and marked upon the cover as "not to be opened till the death or disappearance of Dr. Henry Jekyll."" – still values reputation

Mr. Gabriel John Utterson

The model Victorian gentleman, our moral compass, our detective – these are all roles associated with Utterson, yet I'd argue that he really doesn't do justice to any of these, *"inclin[ing] to Cain's heresy, he used to say quaintly..."* – Utterson is a lawyer through whom the narrative mainly unfolds. He is deeply committed to his friends, these friendships *"like ivy, were the growth of time"*. Our main character approaches the events of the story from a rational perspective, not succumbing to emotion (usually!). At first, U is faced with the dichotomous choice between maintaining J's privacy, or address the growing dilemma of Dr. J's possible blackmail. He is restricted by repute and moral boundaries and it is these boundaries that create tension throughout the novella. However, as the mystery deepens he begins to play an active role in seeking the truth ("mr seek"). He becomes alarmed by J's behaviour and H's cruelty after the murder of Carew but stops after J's assurance – "'Utterson, I swear to God," cried the doctor, "I swear to God I will never set eyes on him again..." – J then gives him a letter which has H's script upon it, however, through Mr. Guest, it turns out they are written and forged – yet Utterson does nothing, **arguably**

making him complicit in the downfall of Henry Jekyll under the feeble excuse of Victorian reputation.

By the end, he is forced to confront the truth, yet even then he is still obsessed with reputation: "If your master has fled or is dead, we may at least save his credit". However, there is no closure to U's storyline, suggesting perhaps no change in the man – he would cover and hide another's reputation, for better or for worse again if faced with the choice.

Key quotes:

- "Mr. Utterson the lawyer was a man of a rugged countenance that was never lighted by a smile; cold, scanty and embarrassed in discourse; backward in sentiment; lean, long, dusty, dreary and yet somehow lovable."
- "something eminently human beacons from his eye"
- "drank gin when he was alone to mortify a taste for vintages"
- "I incline to Cain's heresy..."
- "I wouldn't speak of this note, you know"
- "I would say nothing of this paper"
- "the packet slept in the inmost corner of his private safe"
- "he locked the note into his safe"